

Faction Dashboard Tutorial

This tutorial will walk you through setting up and using the Faction Dashboard with provided example files.

Step 1: Setup the Example Factions

You should have received three faction note files:

- `The Merchant Guild.md`
- `Smuggler's Consortium.md`
- `City Watch.md`

1. **Copy these files** into your Obsidian vault
2. **Open each file** to verify the YAML frontmatter loaded correctly
3. **Create the Faction Dashboard note** by copying the dashboard code into a new note
4. **Switch to Reading mode** to view the interactive dashboard

Step 2: Explore Basic Features

View the Network Diagram

- You should see a network with three main faction nodes
- Notice the different colored lines representing different relationship types
- Observe how factions connect to each other through various relationships

Check the Faction Registry

- Look at the table showing all three factions
- Notice the relationship counts and breakdowns with emoji icons
- See how "The Merchant Guild" has the most total relationships

Test the Filter Feature

1. **Enter "Merchant Guild"** in the filter field above the network diagram
2. Watch how the view focuses on relationships involving the Merchant Guild
3. Try filtering by **"City Watch"** and **"Smuggler's Consortium"**
4. Clear the filter to return to full network view

Step 3: Use Interactive Controls

Radio Button Selection

1. **Click the radio button** for "The Merchant Guild"

2. Click "Focus on Selected Faction"

3. Notice how both maps update to highlight this faction's relationships
4. Try this with the other factions

Explore the Relationship Legend

- Review all the relationship types shown with their emoji icons
- Note which types are currently active in your configuration

Step 4: Add Custom Relationship Types

Now let's add some campaign-specific relationship types that aren't in the default set.

Exercise A: Add "Blackmail" Relationship

1. Open the **Configuration Manager** section
2. **Enter name:** `blackmail_targets`
3. **Choose icon:** Select "🎯" from dropdown or enter a custom emoji like "📷"
4. **Pick color:** Choose "red"
5. Click "Add Type"

The new relationship type should appear in the Available Relationship Types list with a CUSTOM badge.

Exercise B: Add "Information Network" Relationship

1. **Enter name:** `information_sources`
2. **Choose icon:** Enter custom emoji "👤" in the custom field
3. **Pick color:** Choose "blue"
4. Click "Add Type"

Exercise C: Test Your Custom Types

1. Open "The Merchant Guild.md" file in edit mode
2. Add these lines to the YAML frontmatter:

```
yaml
blackmail_targets: ["Corrupt Officials"]
information_sources: ["Harbor Authority", "Caravan Guards"]
```

3. Save the file
4. Return to the **Faction Dashboard** and refresh the view
5. Add your custom types to active using the green "Add" buttons
6. Check the network diagram - you should see new relationship lines

Step 5: Practice Configuration Management

Promote a Custom Type

1. Find your **"blackmail_targets" type** in the Available list
2. Click the **" Default" button** to promote it
3. Notice it now shows as "PROMOTED" - this means it will be automatically detected in faction notes

Create and Test More Relationships

1. Add the **"Safe Houses" relationship**:

- Name:
- Icon: ""
- Color: "gray"

2. Update **"Smuggler's Consortium.md"** with:

yaml

```
safe_houses: ["Dock District", "Underground Tunnels"]
```

3. Add the relationship to active and view the updated network

Step 6: Advanced Features

Use the Debug Tool

1. Expand the **Debug section** (if available)
2. Enter **"Merchant Guild"** in the debug field
3. Click **"Debug Faction"** to see detailed relationship analysis
4. Review the output to understand how relationships are validated

Test Export/Import (if available)

1. Generate a **share code** of your configuration
2. **Copy the code**
3. **Reset to default** configuration
4. **Import your saved code** to restore your custom setup

Step 7: Understanding the Results

What You Should See

- **Network Diagram:** Three interconnected factions with multiple relationship types
- **Custom Relationships:** Your added relationship types appearing in the legend and maps
- **Dynamic Updates:** Changes to faction files automatically reflected in the dashboard

- **Interactive Filtering:** Ability to focus on specific faction relationships

Key Relationship Patterns in the Examples

- **Merchant Guild ↔ Smuggler's Consortium:** Enemies and infiltration
- **City Watch ↔ Smuggler's Consortium:** Law enforcement vs. criminals
- **Merchant Guild ↔ City Council:** Political and economic alliances
- **Everyone ↔ Temple Order:** Mostly neutral relationships

Troubleshooting Common Issues

Custom Types Not Appearing

- Check that you clicked "Add Type" after entering details
- Verify the custom type appears in Available Relationship Types
- Use the green "Add" button to make it active
- Refresh the dashboard view

Faction Not Showing Relationships

- Verify YAML frontmatter syntax (arrays use square brackets)
- Check that relationship type names match exactly
- Use the debug tool to check specific faction relationships

Network Diagram Empty

- Ensure faction files are in the vault and readable
- Check that at least one relationship type is active
- Verify faction names in relationships match actual file names

Next Steps

After completing this tutorial, you can:

- **Add your own factions** using the same YAML format
- **Create custom relationship types** specific to your campaign
- **Build larger faction networks** with complex political relationships
- **Use filtering and focusing** to manage complex faction webs

The dashboard will automatically detect and display any faction notes that follow the YAML frontmatter format, making it easy to expand your faction network as your campaign grows.